

RECSYS CHALLENGE 2026

Conversational Music Recommendation

Co-located with [ACM RecSys 2026](#)

About

The **Music Conversational Recommendation Challenge (Music-CRS)** is a global research competition bridging Natural Language Processing and Recommender Systems. Participants build systems that engage in multi-turn conversations about music, recommend relevant tracks, and generate natural language responses.

The challenge uses **TalkPlayData-Challenge**, a large-scale synthetic multi-turn dialogue dataset grounded in real music listening histories, with pre-extracted multimodal track and user embeddings provided.

Organizing Committee

- Seungheon Doh — KAIST, South Korea
- Sergio Oramas — Pandora/SiriusXM

- Bruno Sguerra — Deezer Research
- Abhinav Bohra — Amazon
- Claudio Pomo — Politecnico di Bari, Italy
- Francesco Barile — Maastricht University, Netherlands

Resources

Conversation Datasets

- Train/Development Dataset: <https://huggingface.co/datasets/talkpl-ai/TalkPlayData-Challenge-Dataset>
- Blind Dataset A (will be released after the challenge):
<https://huggingface.co/datasets/talkpl-ai/TalkPlayData-Challenge-Blind-A>
- Blind Dataset B (will be released after the challenge): #

Recommendation Environments Datasets

The following resources are shared across all datasets (Train, Development, and Blind sets).

- User Metadata: <https://huggingface.co/datasets/talkpl-ai/TalkPlayData-Challenge-User-Metadata>
- Track Metadata: <https://huggingface.co/datasets/talkpl-ai/TalkPlayData-Challenge-Track-Metadata>
- User Embedding: <https://huggingface.co/datasets/talkpl-ai/TalkPlayData-Challenge-User-Embeddings>
- Track Embedding: <https://huggingface.co/datasets/talkpl-ai/TalkPlayData-Challenge-Track-Embeddings>

Code

- Baseline Code: <https://github.com/nlp4musa/music-crs-baselines>
- Evaluation Code: <https://github.com/nlp4musa/music-crs-evaluator>

Tutorial

- [Challenge Tutorial](#) — Video walkthrough & slides

Timeline

31 March 2026	Website online.
10 April 2026	Start RecSys Challenge — Release dataset (Train, Development, Blind A).
17 April 2026	Submission System Open — Leaderboard live (with Blind A dataset).
23 June 2026	Blind Dataset B released, Activate submission system for Blind B dataset.
30 June 2026	End RecSys Challenge.
6 July 2026	Final Leaderboard & Winners — EasyChair open for submissions.
9 July 2026	Upload code of the final predictions.
20 July 2026	Paper Submission Due.

3 August 2026	Paper Acceptance Notifications.
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10 August 2026	Camera-Ready Papers.
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September 2026	RecSys Challenge Workshop at ACM RecSys 2026.
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